

TLP:CLEAR

Honeypot-Based Threat Intelligence

Monthly Report — June 2026

Docker Worm / Escape-to-Host | ELF SSH-worms | Solana Targeting | LLM Abuse | IEC-104 Recon

Parameter	Value
Reporting period	1-30 June 2026 (2026-06-01 — 2026-07-01 UTC)
Analysis date	7 July 2026
Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Threat level	MEDIUM-HIGH
Honeypot nodes	DE, US, RU + IEC-104 (ICS/OT) decoy
Event volume	~870,000 attack sessions/requests across all services
SSH events	497,929 sessions, 433,721 failed logins, 516 payload downloads
Malware samples	70 unique SHA-256 (all malicious)

1. Executive summary

Over June 2026 our distributed honeypot sensors (Germany, the United States and Russia) recorded roughly 870,000 attack sessions/requests across SSH, multi-protocol exploitation, Docker, LLM, MikroTik and Kubernetes surfaces (~2.9M raw Cowrie events including low-level protocol records). The headline development is a self-propagating Docker-API worm performing container-escape to the host: Docker-surface volume grew ~28x month-over-month (~4,300 to ~119,000 events), driven by a single operator.

A second notable shift is in captured malware — May's WannaCry/SMB (PE32 DLL) dominance gave way in June to almost entirely ELF SSH-worms (Panchan, Go SSH-worm, Discord-C2, Mirai/Gafgyt). Solana validator targeting continues, LLM-endpoint abuse persists as a distinct category, and an IEC-104 (ICS/OT protocol) decoy sees steady reconnaissance but zero hands-on control commands from external attackers.

2. Volume summary

SSH (Cowrie), exact counters:

Metric	DE	US	RU	Total
Sessions	228,211	88,586	181,132	497,929
Successful logins	13,991	1,466	4,249	19,706
Failed logins	200,416	83,686	149,619	433,721
Shell commands	4,656	1,221	1,713	7,590
Payload downloads	413	103	0	516

Fleet-aggregate service totals: Dionaea (SMB/MSSQL/MySQL/FTP/SIP) 224,985; Docker API 118,909; Ollama (LLM) 16,729; Winbox (MikroTik) 6,871; Kubelet 3,211. Germany became the busiest SSH sensor this month (228K sessions) and posted an unusually high 6.5% login-success rate — a specific botnet's dictionary matched the decoy credentials. Russia again received zero payload downloads (third consecutive month): attackers reconnoiter (uname) but never deliver.

3. Key finding 1 — Docker-API worm with host escape (headline)

The fake Docker API received 118,909 requests, up ~28x from May. A single operator, 45[.]198[.]224[.]5 (VPSVAULT.HOST LTD, AS215925), accounted for 104,299 of them (88%) and appears in botnet telemetry as the campaign's own node. This single actor drove VPSVAULT.HOST from 157 operator-hits in May to 1,487 in June.

Mechanics reconstructed from containers/create payloads (JA4H cluster po11nn0*): the worm pulls common images (postgres:16, redis:7-alpine, nginx:latest, debian, ubuntu, busybox, alpine), creates a container that mounts the host filesystem, and escapes to the host via chroot /host/mnt/hostfs sh (T1611). The second stage is a base64-encoded command in Cmd, fetching a payload from a second-stage host we are withholding from public IOCs (likely a cryptominer/loader). Request mix: POST 105,642, GET 12,450, DELETE 65. This is a mature, self-spreading Docker worm: exposed Docker API to host escape to second-stage download. A dedicated technical report on this campaign follows separately.

4. Key finding 2 — Captured malware shifts to ELF SSH-worms

70 unique samples, all malicious, predominantly harvested via Cowrie. Unlike May — where ~85 of 126 samples were WannaCry PE32 DLLs off the SMB surface — June's stream is almost entirely ELF: YARA SUSP_XORed_Mozilla_Oct19 (12), Panchan_SSHWorm_Go (10), Go_SSHWorm_Generic (10), Discord_C2_ELF (10), SUSP_ELF_LNX_UPX_Compressed (9, UPX-packed), Mirai_Botnet_Malware (3), plus MAL_ELF_Xlogin and ARM-Mirai. C2-method tags: gafgyt (10), mirai (7), xor (6). Exactly one PE32+ sample this month. ClamAV produced zero detections across all 70 — the capture stream is caught only by YARA/imphash.

Primary droppers (Cowrie file_download):

Dropper	Downloads	Profile
45[.]142[.]142[.]140:8443/dropper_x86	61	single x86
192[.]142[.]28[.]77/bachekuni/ohshit.*	~100	full multi-arch (arm/mips/ppc/sh4/i686/x86...)
51[.]158[.]248[.]122:8517/*	~30	multi-arch + loader
202604157[.]xyz/snh5ye.sh	8	shell loader (domain)

Architecture selection uses `/bin/./uname -s -v -n -r -m` (831) before payload delivery.

5. Key finding 3 — LLM inference-endpoint abuse (ongoing)

The fake Ollama API recorded 16,729 events. Taxonomy: scanning ~79% (12,923), inference/compute theft ~17% (2,810), external/cloud model abuse ~3.4% (557), and just 4 ssrf_cloud_cred events (down sharply from May's ~0.5% share). Targeted endpoints: `/api/tags` (6,154, model inventory), `/api/generate`, `/v1/models`, `/v1/chat/completions`, `/api/pull`, plus `/etc/passwd` (36, LFI probe).

Requests reference both local models (qwen2.5:7b, llama3.1:8b, codellama:13b) and paid cloud models (glm-5.2:cloud, deepseek-v4-pro:cloud, minimax-m3:cloud, kimi-k2.7-code:cloud) — attempts to proxy commercial inference through the decoy. The dominant scanning tool shifted from May's official Ollama Go-client to node-fetch/1.0 (4,843), alongside Go-http-client, axios, security-scan, the commercial EchelonGraph-ShadowAIRadar and Umai-Scanner.

6. Key finding 4 — SSH brute-force and Solana targeting

Leading source IPs: 45[.]148[.]10[.]183 (41,425), 45[.]156[.]87[.]254 (34,598), 45[.]148[.]10[.]240 (30,052), 2[.]57[.]122[.]177, 94[.]154[.]35[.]215, 185[.]246[.]128[.]133, 176[.]65[.]132[.]24. Dictionaries still carry Solana-specific credentials — usernames sol (5,906), solana (5,773), solv (3,050); passwords solana (1,796), sol (1,614) — a botnet hunting Solana validators for key theft/staking redirection. New this month: usernames claud (2,173), openclaw (1,636) and frappe (1,524, ERPNext).

7. Key finding 5 — ICS/OT protocol decoy (IEC-104)

An IEC-104 (ICS/OT) protocol decoy recorded, over a full month of observation, external attacker activity of 758 connects and 67 General Interrogations (ASDU data-point enumeration) with zero control commands — reconnaissance only. Sources span 267 unique external IPs, predominantly cloud scanners performing mass ICS census rather than targeted intrusion. Simulation and setup/debug artifacts, and traffic from our

own authorized red-team vantage, are excluded from these figures. Takeaway: internet-wide IEC-104 reconnaissance is routine, but hands-on manipulation of the emulated control logic was entirely absent.

8. Source operators and geography

Leading source operators (passive ASN attribution): DigitalOcean (6,468), OVH (1,707), VPSVAULT.HOST (1,487 — Docker worm), Alibaba Cloud (666), Amazon AWS (364), GCS (158), M247 (95); sanctioned/bulletproof carry low volume — Aeza (31), Proton66 (10), UFO Hosting/Stark (5). Leading source countries by attack volume: US (29,897), CN (8,016), NL (7,355), RO (3,709), DE (3,350), SG (2,906), RU (2,692), HK, GB, VN. The bulk originates from mainstream clouds (rented-VPS botnets); this month the targeted Docker-worm load came from VPSVAULT.HOST.

9. Botnet campaigns

~7 tracked campaigns spanning ~78 attacker IPs; ~2,930 botnet attacks against ~43 sensor endpoints. Active C2 hosts include 217[.]60[.]195[.]113 (AE, size up to 19), 14[.]46[.]136[.]77 (KR, up to 13, carried over from May) and 213[.]108[.]21[.]95 (NL, AS210644 Aeza, sanctioned).

10. MITRE ATT&CK

- T1595.002 — Active Scanning: Vulnerability Scanning
- T1110 — Brute Force
- T1046 — Network Service Discovery
- T1190 — Exploit Public-Facing Application
- T1610 — Deploy Container
- T1611 — Escape to Host (Docker worm)
- T1496 — Resource Hijacking
- T1552.005 — Cloud Instance Metadata API
- T0846 — Remote System Discovery (IEC-104 connect, ICS)
- T0888 — Remote System Information Discovery (General Interrogation, ICS)

11. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Machine-readable dumps — iocs.stix2.json (STIX 2.1) and iocs.misp.json (MISP) — ship alongside this report. All indicators are defanged in human-readable documents and refanged in the JSON bundles. Note: the live Docker-worm second-stage host is withheld from these indicators and from external community feeds.

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